

Sausage trees

Cones got their name because some, such as pinecones, are conical in shape. However, spruce cones are more like sausages, hanging down from the tree. Their needles also point downward, helping them to shed snow.



Spruce needles have square sides.



The leaf tips of monkey puzzle trees have sharp spines.

Monkey puzzle

The monkey puzzle is an umbrella-shaped tree with sharply pointed leaves, which are arranged in a spiral. Also called the Chile pine, these trees are found in Chile and Argentina.

Conifers have flexible branches so that heavy snow and ice can slide off, which stops them from breaking.

TRACKING ANIMALS IN SNOW

Look for tracks in the snow—deer, crows, and squirrels live in the large coniferous forests of the north.



Deer



Crow



Squirrel

Back paw

Front paw